

Mridula Raul

CSE DS

Company: Barclays

Job Profile: Summer Intern 2025

Offer Type: Internship Only

Internship Stipend: 75000/month

Location: Pune, Maharashtra

Process Date: 12/09/2024

Placement Process:

1. Online Assessment [240 students appeared, 27 selected]

This was an online round, conducted offline at the college, with a duration of 1.5 hours. It consisted of 14 questions: 1 medium-level DSA coding question, 1 easy-level SQL query, and 12 MCQs. The MCQs focused on fundamental concepts of Java, OOPS, and DBMS.

Make sure to review the core concepts of OOPS, DBMS, and basic SQL queries. For the coding question, submit your code even if it only passes partial test cases.

2. Technical Interview [27 students appeared, 15 were selected]

In this round, the interviewer focused mainly on my resume, and the interview lasted about 20 minutes. He began by asking me to share something about myself that wasn't included in my resume.

He then asked me to explain each project listed on my resume and the motivation behind them. I explained why I chose each project. I gave an overview of the features, frameworks/languages used, and the event flow for each project.

He also asked in-depth questions about the keywords in my project section, like APIs and machine learning models. He asked, "What are APIs?", "What are API response codes?", "What is an API token and why is it important?", and "Have you built an API?" For the college recommendation app I worked on, I explained the ML model, even though it was handled by another team member, emphasizing the need to fully understand all aspects of a project.

The interviewer pointed out flaws in my projects, and I explained my approach to fix them and why the issues occurred. For example, in a 24-hour hackathon, time constraints prevented full implementation. He also asked how I would implement security layers in each project.

We discussed the Flutter framework and Firebase. He asked if I had experience with NoSQL databases, to which I responded that Firebase Realtime Database is a NoSQL database. When asked about AWS and Kafka, I admitted I had read about them but didn't have in-depth knowledge.

Lastly, he presented a scenario: if a transaction occurred in Mumbai at 11:20, followed by another in Pune 20 minutes later, how would I detect fraud? I acknowledged that I wasn't sure of the exact technology to use, but my approach would involve calculating the time difference and distance between the two locations to determine if the transaction was possible.

For this round, it's important to answer honestly. You're not expected to know everything, but relate what you do know to the topic.

3. **HR Interview Round** [15 students appeared, 13 were selected]

This round was mainly HR-focused, but the interviewer also asked some basic technical questions. It lasted about 20-25 minutes.

He began by asking which programming languages I've worked with. I mentioned that my primary language is C++, but I also have knowledge of Java, Python, and Dart. Then he asked me to explain Object-Oriented Programming, what polymorphism is, where I've implemented it, and the difference between the two types of polymorphism.

After that, the HR questions started. He asked what challenges I faced during my internship. I explained that I encountered issues deploying the app on the Play Store due to Google policy conflicts, and I described how I resolved those issues.

Next, he asked why I chose Barclays and followed up with a few more questions based on my response. He then presented a hypothetical situation: What would I do if a superior said something rude to me in a meeting? He also asked how I would handle it if a junior told me I had spoken rudely to them, and how I would manage two team members arguing during a meeting if I were the team leader. For these questions, ensure your answers align with the company's values.

He also asked me to describe a situation where I experienced conflict with teammates and to share an experience where I led a team. I described my experience as the Mudra domain head here.

For HR questions, it's important to understand the company's values and tailor your answers accordingly.

13 students were offered the Summer Internship.

Useful Tips:

- Be confident and answer in a structured manner.
- Make sure to be thorough with your resume.
- Research the company beforehand and adjust your resume and answers to fit their requirements. (Barclays expects proficiency in Java and SQL.)
- Reassure the interviewer that even if you're unfamiliar with a certain topic, you're eager and ready to learn it.